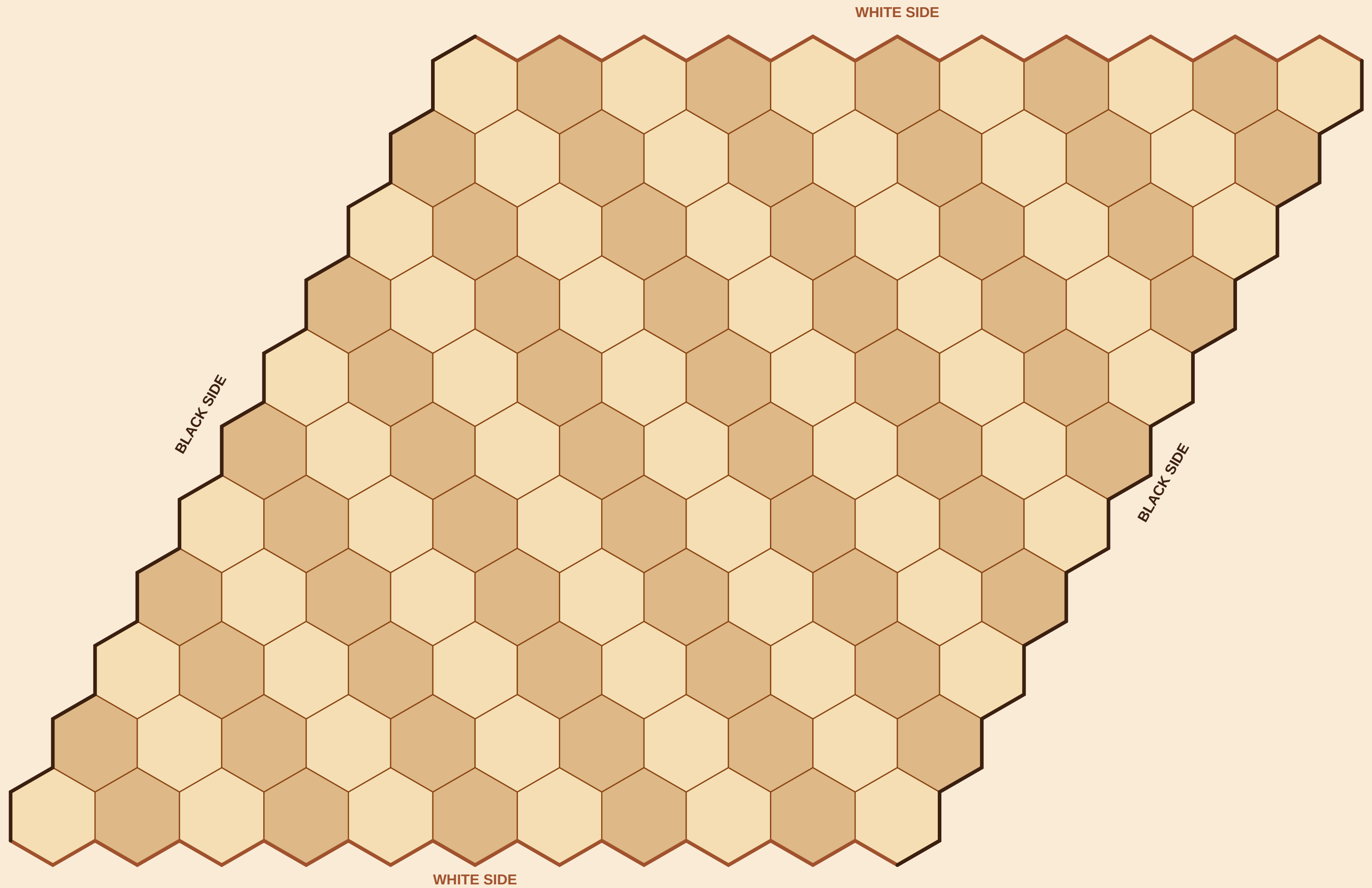




How to Play Hex

Invented by Piet Hein (1942) • Rediscovered by John Nash (1949)

Players

Two players. One plays White Side, the other plays Black Side.

Setup

Use the board on the previous page with your stone set. Each player has stones of their own color. Decide who goes first (typically the Black player).

Goal

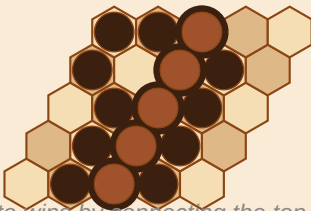
Be the first to form a connected chain of your own stones linking your two assigned sides of the board.

How to play

On your turn, place a stone of your color on any empty hex cell, centered within the hex. Stones are never moved or removed.

Win condition

Connect your two opposite sides with a chain of your stones. A draw is impossible — the Brouwer fixed-point theorem guarantees one player must win.



Example: White wins by connecting the top and bottom edges.

The swap rule (recommended for fairness)

After the first player makes their opening move, the second player may choose to either keep their color or swap colors. This largely nullifies the first-move advantage.

Coordinate notation

Columns use standard Go notation: a–h, then j–z (the letter i is skipped, per Go convention). Rows are numbered 1–N from bottom to top. A cell's address is column+row, e.g. “f7” refers to column f, row 7.